1. He/she maintains order and decorum in the House for conducting its business and regulating its proceedings. This is his/her primary responsibility and he/she has final power in this regard.

2. He/she is the final interpreter of the provisions of (a) the Constitution of India, (b) the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business of Lok Sabha, and (c) the parliamentary precedents, within the House.

3. He/she adjourns the House or suspends the meeting in absence of a quorum. The quorum to constitute a meeting of the House is one-tenth of the total strength of the House.

4. He/she does not vote in the first instance. But he/she can exercise a casting vote in the case of a tie. In other words, only when the House is divided equally on any question, the Speaker is entitled to vote. Such vote is called casting vote, and its purpose is to resolve a deadlock.

5. He/she presides over a joint setting of the two Houses of Parliament. Such a sitting is summoned by the President to settle a deadlock between the two Houses on a bill.

6. He/she can allow a 'secret' sitting of the House at the request of the Leader of the House. When the House sits in secret, no stranger can be present in the chamber, lobby or galleries except with the permission of the Speaker.

7. He/she decides whether a bill is a money bill or not and his/her decision on this question is final. When a money bill is transmitted to the Rajya Sabha for recommendation and presented to the President for assent, the Speaker endorses on the bill his/her certificate that it is a money bill.

8. He/she decides the questions of disqualification of a member of the Lok Sabha, arising on the ground of defection under the provisions of the Tenth Schedule. In *Kihoto Hollohan* case[10] (1992), the Supreme Court ruled that the decision of the Speaker in this regard is subject to judicial review.

9. He/she acts as the *ex-officio* chairman of the Indian Parliamentary Group which is a link between the Parliament of India and the various parliaments of the world. He/she also acts as the *ex-officio* chairman of the conference of presiding officers of legislative bodies in the country.

10. He/she appoints the chairman of all the parliamentary committees of the Lok Sabha and supervises their functioning. He/she is the chairman of the Business Advisory Committee, the Rules Committee and the General Purposes Committee.

Independence and Impartiality As the office of the Speaker is vested with great prestige, position and authority, independence and impartiality becomes its *sine qua non*[11].

The following provisions ensure the independence and impartiality of the office of the Speaker:

1. He/she is provided with a security of tenure. He/she can be removed only by a resolution passed by the Lok Sabha by an effective majority (ie, a majority of all the then members of the House) and not by a simple majority (ie, a majority of the members present and voting in the House). This motion of removal can be considered and discussed only when it has the support of at least 50 members.

2. His/her salaries and allowances are fixed by Parliament. They are charged on the Consolidated Fund of India and thus are not subject to the annual vote of Parliament.